



*T&C Apply

MEGA VALUE OFFERS

ABC
CARGO & COURIER

800 916
www.abccargo.com



Virendra Saklani/Gulf News

CRICKET THE WINNER IN DUBAI

Pakistan's opening batsman Sahibzada Farhan plays a shot as Indian wicketkeeper Sanju Samson looks on in the DP World Asia Cup final at Dubai International stadium yesterday. The excitement surrounding the match was made even more special yesterday by the fact that it was their first final meeting in the tournament's 41-year history. Fans from nations called for more thrilling contests. **SEE ALSO P12, FOR UPDATES, LOG ON TO GULFNEWS.COM**

NATION
'Do not miss the beat' initiative to promote heart health | P2

PROPERTY
Etihad Rail boost to Dubai homes: 7 locations to see big changes | P7



NATION
Expat caring for 65 rescued cats faces eviction in Dubai | P3

BUSINESS
UAE gold market adapts as prices hit record highs | P5

Subscribe in print and online
www.store.gulfnews.com
www.gulfnews.com/subscriptions
Tel: 600 587 234
E mail: circ@gulfnews.com

PRICE UAE: Dh 5.00	Bahrain: BD 0.500 Oman: RO 0.500 India: Rs 40.00	S Arabia: SR 5.00 Pakistan: Rs 100.00
--------------------	--	--

Self-driving taxis tick right boxes in Dubai

No safety incidents reported in Dubai Festival City, Zabeel and Jumeirah

DUBAI
BY ASHWANI KUMAR
Chief Reporter

Chinese technology giant Baidu's robotaxi arm, Apollo Go has completed hundreds of trial rides of its self-driving RT6 cars in Dubai's Jumeirah, Dubai Festival City and Zabeel, with zero safety incidents reported. Liang Zhang, Managing Director of EMEA at Baidu Apollo, said: "We provided at least 40 trips to invited passengers from RTA, and it was 100 per cent success with zero intervention from the safety driver. So, it's quite perfect." Baidu Apollo began working with Dubai's Roads and Transport Authority (RTA) in March. By April, its first batch of vehicles had arrived, and road trials started

in May. Within four and a half months, 50 cars were deployed for testing. By July, the company secured a milestone: Dubai's first autonomous driving test licence plate (No 001) and open-road permits from RTA. Today, Baidu Apollo is authorised to operate in Zone 1 and Zone 2, including some of the city's busiest districts. "RTA defines testing zone from 1 to 4," Zhang said. "Right now, we have the green light to do the testing in zone 1 and zone 2, including Jumeirah, Festival City and Zabeel area." Initially, Dubai Silicon Oasis acted as a regulatory "sandbox" where cars underwent initial validation. The company now hopes to "unlock" Zones 3 and 4, which represent the core of Dubai's transport network. Baidu Apollo plans to go fully driverless in Dubai by Q1 2026, making the city its first global market outside China. It operates one of the world's largest autonomous fleet in China. **SEE ALSO P3**

Anger, grief in Tamil Nadu after 40 killed at Vijay rally

Power cut, wrong calls and a fallen branch trigger panic

DUBAI
BY STEPHEN N.R.
Senior Associate Editor

Anger and grief swept Karur after a stampede at a Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK) rally for actor-turned-politician Vijay left 40 people dead and 100 injured. Organisers expected 10,000, but officials say 27,000-30,000 gathered with only 500 police deployed. Crowds arrived early in blistering heat after social posts said Vijay would come at midday; he reached the venue around 7.40pm.

Videos show him atop a campaign vehicle handing out water and pleading for police help as the crowd surged. Reports point to multiple triggers - a power cut, incorrect announcements, a falling tree branch and hundreds chasing the convoy - that together sparked panic and a fatal crush. Local media reported that Vijay left the venue immediately after the stampede and returned to his Chennai beach house, a move that fuelled public anger. TVK has accused the ruling DMK of a criminal conspiracy and has petitioned the Madras High Court for an SIT or CBI probe. **SEE ALSO PAGE 11**

Iran angry after UN sanctions reimposed

ASSET FREEZES, BANKING CURBS TIGHTEN THE SQUEEZE

DUBAI
BY STEPHEN N.R.
Senior Associate Editor

BACK AFTER DECADE

- Trigger:** Britain, France, Germany (E3) invoked the deal's snapback.
- Targets:** Suppliers to Iran's nuclear/missile work.
- Measures:** Asset freezes, arms ban, tech embargo, travel bans.
- Finance:** Banking access curbed; violators risk global asset freezes.
- Economy:** Rial ≈ 1.1m/\$1 - inflation and food prices spike.
- EU:** Complementary EU sanctions can be reimposed to deepen pressure.

Iran braced for confrontation yesterday after UN sanctions lifted a decade earlier slammed back into force under the nuclear deal's "snapback" clause - freezing overseas assets, reimposing an arms embargo and pushing the country closer to economic rupture as the rial plunged to fresh lows. Parliament erupted in fury, denouncing the move as "unjustifiable" and rushing into closed-door emergency sessions that put withdrawal from the Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty on the table - a prospect experts warn could echo North Korea and sharply raise the risk of wider conflict.

Warnings

Senior commanders in both the regular military and the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps issued blunt warnings that forces stood ready to retaliate, while hardline law-

makers promised reciprocal measures against the three European initiators. The snapback was triggered by Britain, France and Germany after months of stalled diplomacy. The sanctions arrive as Iran sits on a substantial uranium stockpile enriched up to 60%

- a technical step short of weapons grade - and after a period in which Tehran restricted IAEA access, deepening mistrust.

'We'll be ruined'

Western capitals insisted diplomacy remains possible if Iran returns to substantive talks, but also framed the snapback as essential to prevent further nuclear advance. For now, Iran faces a stark choice: reopen negotiations to relieve immediate economic suffering or harden its stance - a decision that will determine whether the snapback marks a return to containment or the start of a far more dangerous chapter. Across the capital, frustration and anxiety mixed as many wondered how much worse life could get. "We'll be ruined. Ordinary people really might not be able to live the way they do now," Nassim Company, a woman who works as a researcher in the city, told AFP.

SEE ALSO PAGE 9

GULF NEWS

Your Daily Gold Guide

Gold Rates Across GCC & India.

Visit: www.gulfnews.com/gold-forex

Available on all major platforms. Download Now!

Download on the App Store

GET IT ON Google Play

EXPLORE IT ON AppGallery